FREE TUTORIAL

Claude motion videos, *step by step.*

7 styles, the exact prompts, and the workflow I used to make every one of them with Claude Opus 5.5. No After Effects. No keyframes.



01 02 03 04 05 06 07

Inside: setup · workflow · base block · 7 prompts · fixes

[what you'll make]

Seven styles, seven *looks*

Each style changes the palette, the line quality, the motion and the sound, so no two videos look alike. Every one is under 10 seconds and built for a vertical reel.

#	STYLE	MOTION FEEL	SOUND	DIFFICULTY
01	**One-line graph**	Continuous, the pen never lifts	Marimba, pen scratch	MEDIUM
02	**One-ball showreel**	Hard snaps, short holds	128 BPM electronic	EASY
03	**ASCII terminal**	Smooth 3D in a rigid grid	Minimal techno, key clicks	MEDIUM
04	**Pixel dither**	Stepped, animated on twos	8-bit chiptune	EASY
05	**Risograph stop motion**	Stop motion on threes	Toy piano, paper foley	MEDIUM
06	**Renaissance codex**	Hand rhythm, one fast flight	Lute, quill scratch	HARD
07	**Ink in water**	Slow motion, organic	Ambient piano, no drums	HARD

<10s
LENGTH OF EVERY VIDEO

1
PROMPT PER VIDEO

0
KEYFRAMES SET BY HAND

WHERE TO START

Start with **Pixel dither** or **the one-ball showreel**. They work in one or two rounds. Save Renaissance codex and Ink in water for when you know the loop.

[setup]

Set up in five *minutes*

You need Claude Code and a paid Claude plan. Claude writes every frame as code, then renders it into a video on your computer.

STEP 01

Install Claude Code

Get it from **claude.com/claude-code** and sign in with your Claude account.

STEP 02

Make a project folder

One folder per video keeps the files clean. Open Claude Code inside it.

```
mkdir motion-01
cd motion-01
claude
```

STEP 03

Pick Opus 5.5

Type **/model** and choose Opus 5.5.

STEP 04

Set effort to high or above

The default is medium. Higher effort means more checking of its own frames, which is what makes motion look polished.

```
/effort high    # good default for these
/effort max     # best results, burns usage fast
```

STEP 05

Approve the render tools

The first time, Claude asks to install a video encoder and a headless browser so it can turn the animation into an MP4. **Say yes.**

Note: max effort only lasts for the current session. Set it again each time you open Claude Code.

[the workflow]

Prompt, review, *iterate*

The same loop works for all seven styles. The storyboard step is the one most people skip, and it saves you the most time.

01 · PASTE

Paste a style prompt, then the base block under it. Add a reference image or a frame from a video you like if you have one. Claude can read it and match the look.

02 · STORYBOARD

Review the storyboard first. You get a beat map with timestamps and 4 key stills. Approve it, or redirect before any code gets written.

03 · BUILD

Claude builds the animation in code and makes the soundtrack. Music and every sound effect are synthesized, so there's nothing to license.

04 · CHECK

Check the contact sheet and the MP4. Claude reviews its own frames first. Then you watch it and point at what to change by timestamp.

05 · ITERATE

Change the concept, the colours or the music. Claude edits the same file. It doesn't start over.

06 · EXPORT

Claude renders the final MP4 into your project folder, ready to post.

[the base block]

Paste this under *every* prompt

The style prompts describe what the video looks like. The base block tells Claude how to build it: the format, the soundtrack, and to stop at the storyboard.

BASE BLOCK · COPY ALL OF IT

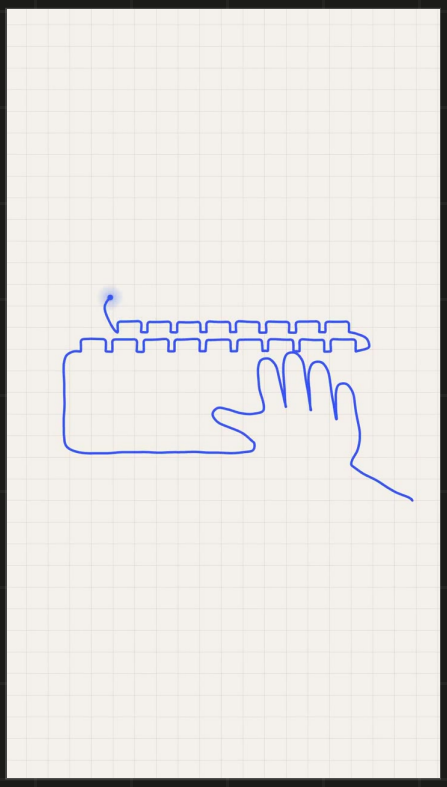
```
FORMAT: 1080x1920 vertical, 30fps, under 10 seconds.
BUILD: one self-contained HTML file. Every frame is drawn on canvas as a pure function of time (seek(t)). No timers, no CSS transitions, seeded randomness only. Render to MP4 with Playwright + ffmpeg.
SOUND: synthesize the music and every sound effect in code. Lock every hit to the visual beat. Mix to -14 LUFS and mux into the MP4.
PROCESS: show me the storyboard first: a beat map with timestamps and 4 key stills as PNGs. Stop and wait for my approval before you build anything. After rendering, export a contact sheet (one frame per beat), review it yourself, fix anything weak, then show me the final.
RULES: keep text out of the top 250px and bottom 400px (Reels UI). No crossfades, no generic gradients, no glow spam, nothing that looks like a template.
```

[anatomy of a style prompt]

PART	WHAT IT DOES
OPENING LINE	What it is, how long, which format. This line alone already makes a decent video.
IDEA	The one device that carries the whole film. One idea, not a feature list.
BEATS	One line per time range: what's on screen, what moves, the exact words.
LOOK	Background, palette with hex codes, type, texture.
MOTION	Where it's fast, where it holds, how scenes hand over.
SOUND	Tempo, instruments, and one sound for each action.

One continuous *line*

A single blue pen stroke starts as a line graph, then keeps drawing new shapes without ever lifting.



FRAME FROM MY RENDER

#F4F1EA #DAD5CA #2F5BFF

LENGTH	8 sec
MOTION	Continuous, the pen never lifts
SOUND	Marimba, pen scratch
LEVEL	Medium

THE PROMPT · + BASE BLOCK UNDER IT

An 8-second vertical motion graphic drawn entirely with ONE continuous line that never breaks or lifts.

IDEA: a single electric-blue line starts as a line graph, then peels off the chart and keeps drawing, turning into new shapes. The line is the only moving thing. It ends by writing "motion" in continuous script.

0-1.5s: off-white graph paper, faint grid. A dot appears bottom left and draws a jagged line graph left to right, values climbing. Axis ticks pop in as it passes.
1.5-3.0s: at the peak the line overshoots the chart, loops once, and the whole graph unravels into the same line pulling upward.
3.0-4.5s: the line draws a single-line portrait of a hand on a keyboard, one stroke, like a continuous-line illustration.
4.5-6.0s: the hand unravels and the line spirals into a play button shape, then a soundwave that pulses three times.
6.0-8.0s: the wave flattens and writes "motion" in one continuous script stroke, centred. A small mono caption "ONE LINE. ONE PROMPT." fades up beneath. Hold.

LOOK: off-white #F4F1EA, grid lines #DAD5CA at 1px, line in electric blue #2F5BFF at 6px with a round cap and a very slight ink wobble. A small glowing dot at the pen tip. No fills, no other colours, no shadows.
MOTION: the pen tip moves at a steady drawing speed, accelerating only on long straight runs. Each new shape forms by the old one unravelling, never by cutting or fading. The camera drifts slowly to follow the pen tip.
SOUND: light marimba and plucked bass around 110 BPM. A soft pen-scratch texture that follows the drawing speed, a tick on each axis mark, a bright pluck as each new shape completes. No narration.

IF IT GOES WRONG

If the line breaks, say: “The line must be one unbroken path. Check every frame.”

The one-ball *showreel*

Five motion techniques in eight seconds, all carried by one red ball. Built on the prompt that went viral.



FRAME FROM MY RENDER

#111116	#EFEBE4	#FF3319	#2A42FF

LENGTH	8 sec
MOTION	Hard snaps, short holds
SOUND	128 BPM electronic
LEVEL	Easy

THE PROMPT · + BASE BLOCK UNDER IT

```
Make a dynamic 8-second motion graphics video that shows what an
incredible motion designer you are, like it's your showreel for a
résumé. Go all out.

IDEA: one small red ball (#FF3319) is in every shot. Each chapter is
a different motion technique acting on it. At the end it becomes the
full stop of the word "MOTION".

0-1.2s: off-black frame, white ground line. The ball drops and
bounces three times with real squash and stretch, then scales up to
flood the screen red.
1.2-2.6s: on red, "MOTION" slams in letter by letter in huge black
heavy grotesque caps. A white line slices it, the halves slide apart
and snap back.
2.6-4.0s: cream background. A rotating sphere of dots orbits the
ball, flattens into a ring, a black circle swallows it.
4.0-5.2s: a grid of dots ripples out from the ball and flips into
red, white and cobalt diamonds in waves. A cobalt circle wipes.
5.2-6.4s: segmented rings rush toward camera around the ball like a
tunnel, then collapse to black.
6.4-8.0s: the ball bursts into shards that snap together into
"MOTION" with the ball as its full stop. "MADE WITH CLAUDE" types on
beneath in small mono caps. Hold.

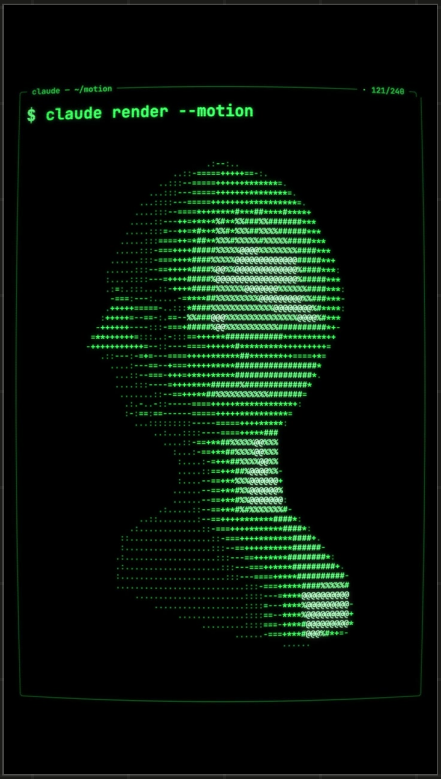
FRAME: thin overlay throughout: corner brackets, chapter counter
"01 / 05" top right, running timecode bottom right, all inside the
safe zone.
LOOK: off-black #111116, cream #EFEBE4, red #FF3319, cobalt #2A42FF.
Flat shapes only. Extra-bold geometric grotesque plus monospace
labels.
MOTION: snaps of 2-4 frames against short readable holds. Real weight
on bounces. Hard cuts on the beat.
SOUND: 128 BPM electronic beat, crisp hats, sub bass. Wooden thud on
each bounce, clicks per letter, a blade slice, ticks on the grid
flips, a riser into the tunnel, a beat of silence, then a shatter and
deep bass hit on the wordmark. No narration.
```

IF IT GOES WRONG

One object in every shot is what makes it feel like a reel, not a list of effects. Keep the ball.

ASCII *terminal*

A 3D head built only from text characters, spinning inside a terminal. It looks like Claude Code is drawing it.



FRAME FROM MY RENDER

#000000 #33FF66

LENGTH	8 sec
MOTION	Smooth 3D in a rigid grid
SOUND	Minimal techno, key clicks
LEVEL	Medium

THE PROMPT · + BASE BLOCK UNDER IT

An 8-second vertical motion graphic where everything is rendered ONLY with monospace text characters, like a 3D demo running inside a terminal.

IDEA: a 3D object made entirely of ASCII characters spins inside a terminal window. Brightness maps to characters: " .:-=+*#%@". It feels like Claude Code itself is drawing.

TECH: render 3D geometry yourself, sample brightness into a character grid of about 90 columns, and draw each cell as a monospace glyph. No pixels outside the glyph grid.

0-1.0s: black terminal. A blinking cursor types "$ claude render --motion" character by character.
1.0-3.0s: an ASCII torus fades up from sparse dots to dense characters and spins in 3D. Lighting rotates so the characters ripple from "." to "@".
3.0-4.5s: the torus morphs into a rotating ASCII human head (simple low-poly bust), still spinning.
4.5-5.5s: glitch: rows of characters shift sideways, some cells flip to random symbols, then lock back.
5.5-7.0s: the head shatters into falling characters that pile up at the bottom, then fly up and arrange into a huge ASCII-art "MOTION".
7.0-8.0s: a status line types beneath: "rendered 240 frames. 0 keyframes." Cursor blinks. Hold.

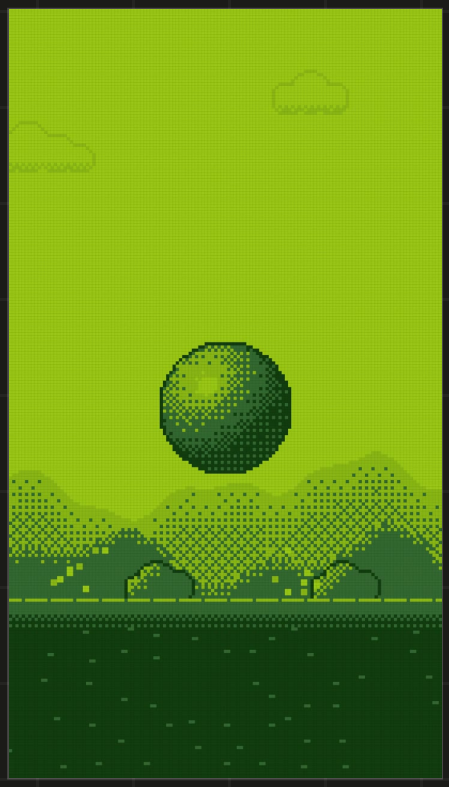
LOOK: pure black #000000. Characters in phosphor green #33FF66 with a faint glow, brightest characters slightly whiter. Subtle CRT curvature, scanlines and flicker. One monospace font throughout.
MOTION: smooth 3D rotation inside a rigid character grid. Typing is linear. Glitches are 2-3 frames.
SOUND: dark minimal techno around 124 BPM. Mechanical keyboard clicks for typing, a CRT hum underneath, data chirps on the glitch, a cascade of tiny ticks as the characters fall, a deep hit when "MOTION" locks. No narration.

IF IT GOES WRONG

If the head looks blurry, ask for a denser character grid, around 120 columns.

Pixel *dither*

A smooth sphere collapses into Game Boy pixels, then bounces through a dithered world.



FRAME FROM MY RENDER

#0F380F #306230 #8BAC0F #9BBC0F

LENGTH	8 sec
MOTION	Stepped, animated on twos
SOUND	8-bit chiptune
LEVEL	Easy

THE PROMPT · + BASE BLOCK UNDER IT

An 8-second vertical motion graphic in low-resolution pixel art with dithering, like a lost Game Boy demo.

IDEA: a smooth, high-res object collapses into pixels, then everything after is pure pixel art. The resolution itself is the effect.

TECH: render the pixel scenes at 135x240, then upscale to 1080x1920 with nearest-neighbour. No anti-aliasing. Use ordered Bayer dithering for all shading. Strict 4-colour palette.

0-1.2s: a smooth, shiny 3D sphere floats in the centre at full resolution.
1.2-2.4s: the resolution steps down on the beat: 1080 → 270 → 68 → 135x240 grid. The sphere becomes a dithered pixel ball.
2.4-4.0s: the pixel ball bounces across a scrolling pixel landscape with parallax hills. Each bounce kicks up 2x2 pixel dust.
4.0-5.2s: glitch: horizontal pixel-sort smears tear across the screen for half a second, then snap clean.
5.2-6.6s: the ball explodes into individual pixels that swarm and reassemble into the chunky pixel word "MOTION".
6.6-8.0s: "MOTION" bounces once, a blinking cursor appears, and "PRESS START" blinks below in tiny pixel font. Hold.

LOOK: Game Boy palette only: #0F380F, #306230, #8BAC0F, #9BBC0F. Thin scanline overlay at low opacity and a faint LCD pixel grid. No gradients except dithering.
MOTION: stepped and chunky. Animate on twos (12fps feel) inside the 30fps render. Snaps are instant, holds are short.
SOUND: 8-bit chiptune around 140 BPM made from square and triangle waves plus a noise channel. A blip on each resolution step, a boing on each bounce, a crunchy bitcrushed burst on the glitch, a rising arpeggio as the pixels reassemble, and a classic coin chime on "PRESS START". No narration.

IF IT GOES WRONG

The best first test. Pixel art hides small flaws, so it usually works in one or two rounds.

Risograph *cutout*

Paper shapes in two riso inks slide, flip and stack like a handmade stop-motion short. Imperfect on purpose.



FRAME FROM MY RENDER

#F3EFE6 #FF48B0 #00838A

LENGTH	9 sec
MOTION	Stop motion on threes
SOUND	Toy piano, paper foley
LEVEL	Medium

THE PROMPT · + BASE BLOCK UNDER IT

```
A 9-second vertical motion graphic that looks like risograph-printed
paper cutouts animated in stop motion.

IDEA: flat paper shapes in two riso inks slide, flip and stack on a
desk like a handmade stop-motion short. Imperfect on purpose.

0-1.5s: textured paper background. Cutout shapes slide in from all
sides in stop motion: a circle, a zigzag, a hand, a star. Each has a
small drop shadow and slightly ragged edges.
1.5-3.0s: the shapes pile up into a cartoon computer. Its screen
flips open like a paper flap.
3.0-4.5s: inside the flap, a paper sun rises and a paper film strip
unrolls across the frame.
4.5-6.0s: the film strip folds like an accordion, each panel showing
one letter.
6.0-7.5s: the panels pop up flat into "MOTION" in chunky cut-paper
letters. A paper hand slides in and pats the last letter down.
7.5-9.0s: confetti scraps fall and settle. A tiny stamped label "MADE
BY CLAUDE" thumps into the corner. Hold.

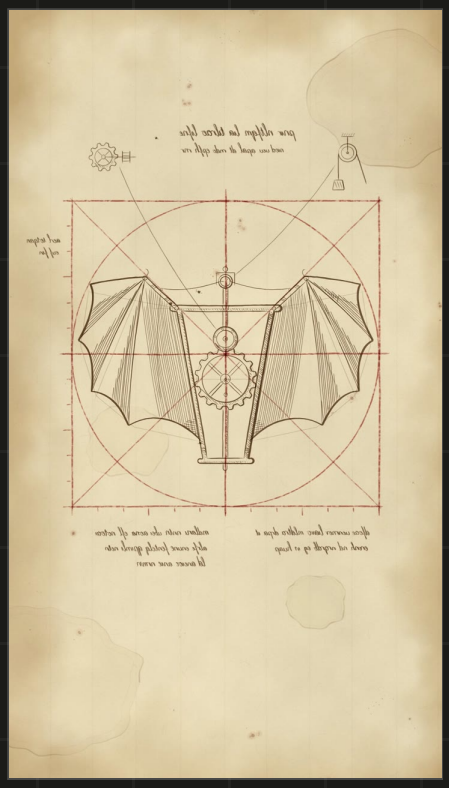
LOOK: off-white uncoated paper #F3EFE6 with fibers. Two riso inks
only: fluoro pink #FF48B0 and teal #00838A, plus their overprint mix.
Visible halftone dots in shading, ink grain, and slight
misregistration (pink offset 3px from teal). Paper drop shadows that
are soft and short. No clean vector look.
MOTION: animate on threes (about 8fps feel) inside the 30fps render,
with tiny frame-to-frame jitter on every shape like real stop motion.
Squash on landings.
SOUND: playful lo-fi with a toy piano, upright bass and brushed
snare, around 100 BPM. Paper slides and rustles, a soft card thump on
each landing, a flap whoosh, an accordion squeeze on the fold, a
rubber stamp thunk at the end. No narration.
```

IF IT GOES WRONG

If it looks too clean and digital, ask for more ink misregistration and more frame-to-frame jitter.

Renaissance *codex*

A quill draws an original flying machine on parchment, then the drawing comes to life and flies off the page.



FRAME FROM MY RENDER

#E9D9B5 #5A3A1E #A4452C

LENGTH	9 sec
MOTION	Hand rhythm, one fast flight
SOUND	Lute, quill scratch
LEVEL	Hard

THE PROMPT · + BASE BLOCK UNDER IT

A 9-second vertical motion graphic in the style of a Renaissance inventor's notebook. It must be an original drawing, not a copy of any real Da Vinci page.

IDEA: a quill draws an invention on aged parchment: construction lines first, then hatching, then annotations. The finished drawing comes to life and flies off the page.

0-1.5s: aged parchment fills the frame. A red chalk circle and square draw as construction geometry, with proportion lines and small measurement ticks.
1.5-3.5s: sepia ink draws an original flying machine inside the geometry: a wooden frame, gears, and two bat-like wings. Lines go down construction first, then outlines, then cross-hatching for shadow.
3.5-4.5s: small annotations in mirror-written, unreadable script fill the margins, plus tiny side diagrams of a gear and a pulley with leader lines pointing to the machine.
4.5-6.5s: the gears start turning, the wings flap with real follow-through, and the ink drawing lifts off the page. Its cast shadow stays on the parchment.
6.5-9.0s: the machine flies up out of frame. The page turns, and on the new page "MOTION" is drawn in sepia ink with a calligraphic flourish. Hold.

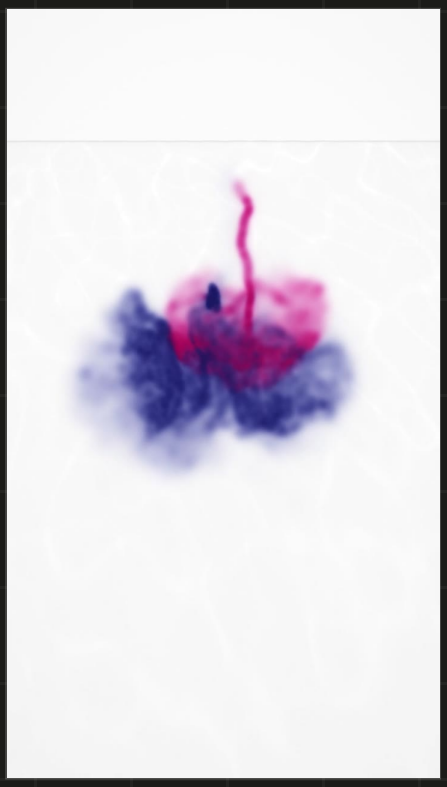
LOOK: parchment #E9D9B5 with stains, foxing and soft vignette. Sepia ink #5A3A1E with varied line weight and occasional ink blots. Red chalk #A4452C for construction lines only. Cross-hatching for all shading. Everything looks hand-drawn with slight wobble. No digital gradients or glows.
MOTION: unhurried drawing speed with a natural hand rhythm: fast strokes, small pauses between them. The flight is the only fast moment. The page turn has real paper curl and shadow.
SOUND: solo lute or harpsichord, slow and warm. Quill scratching that follows every stroke, a soft tap on each ink blot, wooden creaks and clicks when the gears turn, wing flaps, a paper rustle on the page turn. No narration.

IF IT GOES WRONG

Expect 2 to 3 rounds on the hatching. Remind it of the drawing order: construction, outline, then hatching.

Ink in *water*

Thousands of particles behave like ink dropped in water, then slowly condense into a word.



FRAME FROM MY RENDER

#FAFAFA #1B1F6B #C2185B

LENGTH	9 sec
MOTION	Slow motion, organic
SOUND	Ambient piano, no drums
LEVEL	Hard

THE PROMPT · + BASE BLOCK UNDER IT

A 9-second vertical motion graphic of ink dropped into water, built from a particle simulation, that blooms into letters.

IDEA: about 30,000 particles behave like ink in water: they fall, curl and bloom in slow motion, then a flow field gently pulls the cloud into the word "MOTION", which dissolves again.

TECH: simulate particles with curl noise for turbulence, slight gravity and drag. For the letter phase, blend each particle toward a target point sampled from the word's shape. Draw with additive blending at low opacity so dense areas build up rich colour. Seeded randomness so renders are repeatable.

0-1.0s: pure white water tank, a faint surface line at the top. A single drop of ink hits the surface.
1.0-3.5s: the ink plunges and blooms into a slow mushroom cloud, curling tendrils spreading in deep indigo.
3.5-4.5s: a second drop of magenta falls. Where colours overlap they mix into violet swirls.
4.5-7.0s: the turbulence calms. Every particle drifts toward the letterforms, and the cloud slowly condenses into "MOTION", tendrils still curling at the edges.
7.0-9.0s: the word holds for one second, then the bottom edge begins to dissolve back into drifting smoke. End mid-dissolve.

LOOK: clean white #FAFAFA water with subtle caustic light ripples. Ink colours: deep indigo #1B1F6B, magenta #C2185B, and their violet mix. Soft, silky, macro-photography feel. No hard edges, no outlines.
MOTION: slow motion throughout, like 1000fps footage played back. Organic, never linear. The letter formation is gradual, not snapped.
SOUND: cinematic ambient, slow piano notes with long reverb, no drums. A deep underwater plunk on each drop, low muffled rumbles as the ink blooms, a soft rising swell as the letters form, then a long fading tone. No narration.

IF IT GOES WRONG

The heaviest render. If the word doesn't read, ask for more of the particles to settle into the letters.

[fixing it]

What to say when it's *off*

The first render is rarely the final one. Point at a timestamp and say exactly what's wrong. Short, specific follow-ups beat rewriting the whole prompt.

IF YOU SEE THIS	SAY THIS
Text is too small on a phone	`Make all text at least 60px tall at 1080 wide.`
Music doesn't hit the action	`Re-time the soundtrack so every hit lands on the exact frame the motion lands.`
A scene feels empty	`At 3s only the top half of the frame is used. Fill the frame.`
The loop jumps	`Make the first and last frame identical.`
Wrong colours	`Swap the palette to [your hex codes]. Keep everything else.`
It looks too digital	`Add grain, slight wobble on every line, and small frame-to-frame jitter.`
It's too long	`Cut it to 6 seconds. Keep the ending.`
You want a new concept	`Keep the style. Replace the idea with [your idea] and redo the storyboard.`

[before you post]

- [ ] Watch it on your phone, not your laptop
- [ ] Check the first second works with the sound off
- [ ] Make sure no text sits under the Reels buttons
- [ ] Keep the prompt so you can remix the style later

Pick a style. Paste the prompt. Now make your *own.*

Post what you make and tag @janustiu. I want to see it.